

HR POLICY KNOWLEDGE BASE

20-Page RAG-Ready Sample Document

Topics: Casual Leave • Working Hours • Work From Home • Performance Reviews •
Health Benefits • Unauthorized Absence

Version 1.0 | Effective 1 September 2026

1. Document Overview

Purpose

This sample HR policy document is designed as a retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) knowledge source. It provides clear answers to common employee questions about leave, working hours, work-from-home, performance reviews, health benefits, and unauthorized absence.

Document status

Internal HR reference document. Version 1.0. Effective date: 1 September 2026. The organization may amend this policy when business, legal, or operational requirements change.

How to use this document

For RAG applications, each section can be chunked into passages and indexed in a vector database. Questions should be answered using the most relevant policy passages rather than relying on model memory.

Important note

The rules in this document are illustrative sample company policies created for RAG testing and application development. They are not a substitute for an employer's actual HR handbook or applicable law.

2. Quick Answers

Casual leave

Employees are eligible for 12 casual leave days per calendar year, normally credited at 1 day per month. Unused casual leave expires at the end of the calendar year unless a written exception is approved.

Working hours

Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday through Friday, including a one-hour lunch break. Employees are expected to maintain their team's agreed collaboration hours.

Work from home

Eligible employees may work from home up to 2 days per week with manager approval, subject to role requirements, team schedules, and business needs.

Performance reviews

Formal performance reviews are conducted twice a year, generally in June and December. Managers may also provide quarterly check-ins.

Health benefits

Employees receive medical insurance covering hospitalization and eligible outpatient benefits, subject to the insurer's terms. Eligible dependents may be added according to the company plan.

Unauthorized absence

Absence without approval or timely notification may be recorded as unauthorized leave, may result in loss of pay, and may lead to disciplinary action for repeated or serious cases.

3. Casual Leave Policy

Eligibility

Full-time employees are eligible for 12 casual leave days per calendar year. Employees joining during the year receive a prorated entitlement based on completed service months.

Purpose

Casual leave is intended for short-term personal needs, urgent matters, appointments, family requirements, or other situations that do not require a longer leave category.

Request process

Employees should submit a leave request through the designated HR or attendance system before the planned absence whenever reasonably possible.

Approval

Leave is subject to manager approval and operational requirements. Approval should be obtained before taking planned casual leave.

Carry-forward

Casual leave generally cannot be carried forward to the next calendar year and is not encashed unless a separate company rule specifically provides otherwise.

4. Leave Request & Approval

Planned leave

For planned leave of one or two working days, employees should normally request approval at least two working days in advance. Longer leave should be requested as early as practical.

Emergency leave

When an unexpected emergency prevents advance approval, the employee must notify the manager or designated contact as soon as possible and submit the leave request afterward.

Manager responsibility

Managers should review requests promptly, consider staffing requirements, and avoid unnecessary delays.

Conflicting requests

When several employees request leave for the same period, approval may depend on team coverage, business deadlines, and the order in which requests were received.

Record keeping

HR or the designated attendance system maintains the official leave record. Employees should verify that approved leave is reflected correctly.

5. Working Hours

Standard schedule

The standard schedule is Monday through Friday, 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, with a one-hour lunch break. Certain teams may operate different schedules because of customer support, production, or international business requirements.

Attendance

Employees are expected to be available during agreed working hours, attend required meetings, and complete assigned responsibilities.

Flexible arrangements

A manager may approve adjusted start or end times when business needs permit. Such arrangements should be documented through the normal team process.

Overtime

Where overtime is required, employees should follow the company's applicable approval and compensation process. Employees should not assume overtime is approved merely because work continues beyond normal hours.

Breaks

Employees should take reasonable meal and rest breaks while ensuring that required coverage and meetings are maintained.

6. Attendance Expectations

General expectation

Employees are expected to report to work on time, maintain reliable attendance, and communicate promptly when they cannot attend.

Late arrival

Repeated lateness may be reviewed by the manager. Employees should notify their manager when a significant delay is expected.

Early departure

Leaving work early for personal reasons should normally be approved in advance unless an emergency occurs.

Attendance records

Attendance may be recorded through an HR system, access system, timesheet, or another approved method depending on the employee's role.

Corrections

If an attendance record is incorrect, the employee should raise the issue with HR or the manager promptly and provide supporting information when available.

7. Work-From-Home Policy

Eligibility

Employees in roles suitable for remote work may work from home up to two days per week. Eligibility is determined by role, performance, security requirements, and team operating needs.

Approval

Work-from-home days must be requested through the team's approved process and approved by the manager. Approval may be changed when business requirements require on-site presence.

Availability

Employees working remotely must remain reachable during agreed working hours, attend virtual meetings, and maintain normal work responsibilities.

Workspace

Employees are responsible for maintaining a reasonably secure and suitable workspace and protecting company information from unauthorized access.

Exceptions

Temporary additional remote work may be approved for exceptional circumstances, subject to manager and HR approval where required.

8. Remote Work Security

Company information

Employees must protect confidential information while working remotely. Documents, credentials, and customer information must not be exposed to unauthorized persons.

Devices

Company-managed devices should be used where provided. Employees should follow security controls such as screen locking, approved software, and secure authentication.

Networks

Employees should use trusted networks and follow company security requirements. Public or unsecured networks should not be used for sensitive work unless approved security controls are in place.

Meetings

Employees should choose a private location for confidential calls and avoid discussing sensitive business information in public places.

Incident reporting

Lost devices, suspected account compromise, accidental disclosure, or other security incidents must be reported promptly through the organization's security process.

9. Performance Review Cycle

Formal reviews

Formal performance reviews occur twice each year, generally in June and December.

Mid-year review

The June review focuses on progress against goals, strengths, development needs, and priorities for the remainder of the year.

Year-end review

The December review assesses overall performance, goal achievement, behavior, contribution, and development during the year.

Quarterly check-ins

Managers are encouraged to conduct quarterly one-to-one check-ins to discuss progress, obstacles, feedback, and priorities.

Review evidence

Performance discussions should consider agreed goals, measurable outcomes, quality of work, collaboration, customer impact, and role-specific responsibilities.

10. Performance Ratings & Development

Rating approach

Where a rating system is used, managers should evaluate performance against documented expectations and goals. Ratings should be supported by examples and evidence.

Feedback

Employees should receive clear feedback on what is working well and what needs improvement. Feedback should be specific and actionable.

Development plans

Where development needs are identified, the employee and manager should agree on practical actions such as training, mentoring, project assignments, or measurable improvement goals.

Performance concerns

Significant performance concerns should be communicated promptly rather than waiting for the formal review cycle.

Employee response

Employees may provide comments or clarifications during the review process according to the company's HR procedure.

11. Health Benefits Overview

Medical insurance

Eligible employees receive company-sponsored medical insurance subject to the applicable insurer terms, exclusions, limits, waiting periods, and claim procedures.

Hospitalization

The plan may cover eligible hospitalization expenses within the policy limits. Employees should consult the insurer's current policy documents for exact coverage.

Outpatient care

Outpatient consultations, diagnostics, pharmacy, or other expenses may be covered when included in the selected insurance plan.

Dependents

Eligible dependents may be enrolled according to the company's insurance rules and enrollment windows.

Policy changes

Insurance benefits may change at renewal. The current insurer policy and HR benefits communication take precedence over this summary.

12. Health Claims & Support

Cashless treatment

Where supported by the insurer and hospital network, employees may use cashless treatment subject to authorization and policy conditions.

Reimbursement

If reimbursement is available, employees should submit required documents within the insurer's stated deadline.

Documents

Common claim documents may include bills, prescriptions, discharge summaries, diagnostic reports, identification, and claim forms. Exact requirements depend on the insurer.

HR support

HR can help employees understand enrollment and internal processes, but claim approval is determined by the insurer according to policy terms.

Confidentiality

Health-related information should be handled confidentially and only shared with authorized parties who need it for benefits administration.

13. Unauthorized Absence

Definition

An unauthorized absence occurs when an employee does not report to work as required and has not received leave approval or provided an acceptable explanation under the emergency absence process.

Immediate action

If an employee cannot attend work unexpectedly, they should contact their manager or designated attendance contact as soon as possible.

First occurrence

A single unexplained absence may result in a manager or HR inquiry, correction of attendance records, and loss of pay for the affected period where applicable.

Repeated absence

Repeated unauthorized absence may result in formal counseling, written warnings, or other disciplinary measures consistent with company procedure.

Serious cases

Extended or repeated absence without communication may be treated as a serious attendance issue and may lead to further disciplinary action, subject to due process and applicable law.

14. Attendance Escalation Process

Step 1: Contact

The manager attempts to contact the employee and records the attendance issue.

Step 2: Explanation

The employee is given an opportunity to explain the absence and provide relevant information or documentation.

Step 3: Review

HR and the manager review the circumstances, attendance history, and applicable policy.

Step 4: Corrective action

Where appropriate, the organization may issue counseling, a warning, attendance improvement expectations, or another proportionate action.

Step 5: Further action

If the issue continues or is sufficiently serious, additional disciplinary action may be considered under the company's disciplinary procedure.

15. Employee Responsibilities

Know the policy

Employees are responsible for understanding attendance, leave, remote-work, performance, and benefits requirements that apply to their role.

Communicate

Employees should communicate leave needs, unexpected absence, work disruptions, and other relevant issues promptly.

Maintain records

Employees should submit accurate leave requests, timesheets, attendance corrections, and required benefits documents.

Meet commitments

Remote or on-site status does not change the expectation to meet agreed work commitments, quality standards, deadlines, and collaboration requirements.

Ask HR

When a policy situation is unclear, employees should contact HR or their manager before taking action whenever practical.

16. Manager Responsibilities

Fair application

Managers should apply policies consistently and avoid treating similar attendance or leave situations differently without a legitimate business reason.

Timely approvals

Managers should review leave and remote-work requests promptly.

Coverage planning

Managers should plan staffing so that approved leave can be accommodated where reasonably possible.

Performance feedback

Managers should provide regular feedback and document significant performance discussions appropriately.

Escalation

Managers should involve HR when an issue may require formal disciplinary action, involves repeated unauthorized absence, or raises a policy interpretation question.

17. RAG Retrieval Guidance

Recommended chunks

For a RAG system, split this document into meaningful chunks such as policy sections, eligibility rules, approval procedures, and consequences. Keep each chunk self-contained and preserve section titles.

Metadata

Useful metadata fields include document name, policy category, section number, effective date, audience, and version.

Example query

Question: How many casual leaves are available? Relevant passage: Casual Leave Policy states that full-time employees receive 12 casual leave days per calendar year.

Example query

Question: What are the working hours? Relevant passage: Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday through Friday, including a one-hour lunch break.

Grounding

The generated answer should quote or paraphrase the retrieved policy and avoid adding unsupported benefits, exceptions, or penalties.

18. RAG Question Bank

Leave questions

How many casual leaves are available? Can casual leave be carried forward? How far in advance should planned leave be requested? What happens during an emergency?

Working-hours questions

What are the standard working hours? Is flexible timing allowed? What should I do if I will be late? How is attendance recorded?

WFH questions

How many days can I work from home? Who approves WFH? What are my responsibilities while working remotely? Can extra WFH be approved temporarily?

Performance questions

When are performance reviews conducted? Are there quarterly check-ins? What is considered during a review? What happens if performance concerns arise?

Benefits and absence

What health benefits are provided? Can dependents be covered? What happens if I am absent without approval? How does attendance escalation work?

19. FAQ Answer Key

Q: How many casual leaves are available?

A: Full-time employees receive 12 casual leave days per calendar year, generally credited monthly. The entitlement may be prorated for employees who join during the year.

Q: What are the working hours?

A: Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday through Friday, including a one-hour lunch break. Some teams may have different schedules.

Q: What is the work-from-home policy?

A: Eligible employees may work from home up to two days per week with manager approval, subject to role and business requirements.

Q: When are performance reviews conducted?

A: Formal performance reviews are generally conducted twice a year, in June and December, with quarterly check-ins encouraged.

Q: What health benefits are provided?

A: Eligible employees receive medical insurance subject to insurer terms. Hospitalization and other benefits depend on the selected plan and its coverage conditions.

Q: What happens if an employee is absent without approval?

A: The absence may be recorded as unauthorized, may result in loss of pay where applicable, and repeated or serious cases may lead to disciplinary action.

20. Policy Control & RAG Implementation Notes

Source priority

For production use, the organization's latest approved HR handbook should be treated as the authoritative source. This sample document should be replaced or updated with approved company policies.

Version control

Store policy version and effective date as metadata. When a policy changes, index the new version and retire or mark the old version to prevent conflicting retrieval.

Answer behavior

If retrieved information does not answer a question, the RAG assistant should say that the policy does not specify the requested information rather than inventing an answer.

Conflict handling

If two retrieved passages conflict, prefer the latest approved policy version and identify the conflict for HR review when necessary.

Implementation checklist

Extract text → clean sections → chunk content → generate embeddings → store vectors with metadata → retrieve top relevant chunks → generate a grounded answer → optionally show the source section.

End of document

This 20-page sample is intended as a structured HR policy knowledge base for testing RAG retrieval, semantic search, embeddings, and grounded question answering.